

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Canada - Study Permit

Study Permit refusals are decided by an IRCC visa officer under IRPA/IRPR. Most applications are decided on the written file without an interview, which makes a complete, consistent document set especially important.

The most common specific reasons

1. Letter of Acceptance details don't match the application

- Double-check your DLI number, program name, and start date against your Letter of Acceptance before submitting
- If anything on your Letter of Acceptance changes after you apply, tell your DLI so they can reissue it, and update your application

2. Financial evidence doesn't meet the cost-of-living formula

- The required amount (tuition payable, plus the published living-cost figure, plus return transportation) is a formula, not a judgement call - see the Financial Requirements Overview for exactly how it's calculated
- The account and evidence must meet IRCC's accepted forms (bank statements, a GIC from a participating Canadian financial institution, proof of a student/education loan, or a paid tuition/housing receipt) - a technically sufficient balance in an unaccepted form can still be refused

3. Weak or unconvincing study plan

The officer isn't satisfied the program is a genuine, logical step given your academic and career background, or isn't satisfied you understand your own program and its connection to your plans.

- Be specific about why this program and institution, not generic reasons that could apply to any course
- Address any obvious gap or mismatch (e.g. a big jump in field of study, or a long gap since your last qualification) directly rather than leaving it unexplained

4. Missing PAL where one is required

Since the introduction of Canada's international student cap, most (though not all) study permit applicants need a Provincial or Territorial Attestation Letter. Confirm with your DLI whether your situation is exempt or requires one, and include it if so.

5. Incomplete or inconsistent immigration history

- Disclose all previous visas, visits, and refusals - from Canada and any other country - honestly

— An undisclosed prior refusal is treated far more seriously than the refusal itself would have been

A REFUSAL ISN'T FINAL

As with the Visitor Visa, there's no formal appeal for a refused Study Permit. Your realistic options are a fresh, stronger application, or - in narrow circumstances involving a procedural error - judicial review at the Federal Court. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier).